

5. Naming conventions

Intel

When buying a processor, the model number often says quite a lot about the processor. According to the current naming schema the processor name is as follows

The i7 signifies the brand (among i3, i5 and i7), then there are 4 digits of which the first digit signifies the generation and the remaining three numbers signify the position of the



processor in that generation. Naturally processors with higher numbers are better performing ones in that particular brand. The numbers are followed by a few suffixes which signify the line of processors. Here are some suffixes and what they mean

M - Mobile

MX - Mobile Extreme

S - Performance optimised

MQ - Mobile Quad core

T - Power optimised

K - Unlocked multiplier

AMD

AMD doesn't follow the same naming convention throughout their processor line. Unlike Intel, AMD has 2 main line of processors. The FX series and the APU series.

The FX series has multiple conventions under it. For example the FX-6100 is from the FX series, has 6 cores(3 integer clusters) and the number 100 signifies it's position in the 6 core line-up. At the same time we have the FX-8300 and the FX-9370. Going by the earlier convention the FX-8300 should be an 8-core processor and the FX-9370 should be a 9-core processor but they are both 8-core processors. The APU lineup has the same issues with the naming convention. The only way to be absolutely sure is to Google its model number.

6. SKUs

So how do so many models creep up? Why not just stick to 3 models for each performance bracket? This is where marketing comes in as having many SKUs results in more sales. The way SKUs are decided is by binning the processors. Essentially each new architecture results in 1-2 actual processor designs. And as with any manufacturing process there are defects